

Solatel PRD

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1. Overview and Vision

Product name: Solatel

One-line pitch: A global, browser-based, skill-based multiplayer shooter where players pay a small entry fee in crypto and earn real money for every kill, with winnings withdrawable on-chain via Solana.

Why this exists: Real-money, pay-per-kill shooters (e.g. BR1: Infinite) have shown strong viral pull and real demand, with players collectively winning over one hundred thousand dollars in a single month on a competitor platform. Solatel aims to bring this model to a global audience using Solana's near-instant, near-free transactions, making the economics work even at very low buy-ins.

Target audience: Global players first, not restricted to any single country, reached primarily through crypto-native and gaming communities (Discord, X, TikTok). No jurisdiction-specific framing or restriction is applied; access is permissionless via crypto wallets.

Core promise to players: Skill is rewarded directly and quickly. A good player should be able to turn a one-dollar entry into real, withdrawable earnings within minutes of play.

2. Core Gameplay Mechanics

Entry fee: One dollar in crypto (Solana / USDC-SOL) per match.

Kill reward: Approximately 0.90 dollars paid per kill, credited instantly to the player's internal balance. The remaining 0.10 dollars per kill goes to the platform as a fee.

Match size: Small matches of roughly six to ten players, rather than large-scale battle royale, to keep action dense and matches fillable with a smaller player base early on.

Match cadence: Continuous-cycle matches with no fixed start or end time, so players can join at any moment rather than waiting in a lobby for a scheduled start, similar to BR1's model.

Movement and shooting feel: Visual fidelity is a low priority. The priority is that shooting and movement feel responsive, flexible, and satisfying — a genuinely playable first-person shooter core, not just a mechanical demo.

Matchmaking: No skill-based matchmaking at launch. This is deferred until there is enough real player data to build it meaningfully.

Withdrawals: Minimum withdrawal amount of five to ten dollars, paid out on-chain to the player's Solana wallet.

3. Payments and Economy Design

Blockchain: Solana, chosen for near-instant transaction finality (around 100 to 150 milliseconds) and ultra-low fees (around 0.00025 dollars), making it well suited to frequent, small-value transactions.

Deposit flow: Players deposit Solana or supported tokens (e.g. USDC-SOL), which convert into an internal ledger balance in the backend database. This is not on-chain per transaction.

In-match flow: Kills and match outcomes update the player's internal ledger balance instantly. No on-chain transaction happens during a match — this keeps gameplay fast and avoids per-kill blockchain fees or delays.

Withdrawal flow: Only withdrawals trigger a real on-chain Solana transaction, sending funds from the treasury back to the player's connected wallet. Minimum withdrawal: five to ten dollars.

Treasury: Recommended as a multi-signature wallet for security, rather than a single-key wallet, to reduce risk of a single point of failure or compromise.

Payment processor options considered:

- Plisio — non-custodial, lighter identity requirements, good for starting lean.
- NOWPayments — supports SOL and USDC-SOL, fees starting around 0.4 percent, no mandatory merchant KYC.
- Crossmint — enterprise-grade, bundles wallets, deposits, withdrawals, and compliance, but requires full KYC/KYB.

Current plan: Start with a lighter processor (Plisio or NOWPayments) using personal national ID, then register a formal company and move to full KYB once the platform scales and starts handling meaningful volume from a global player base.

4. Technical Architecture and Stack

Game engine: Bevy (Rust), chosen after comparing it against alternatives like PlayCanvas. Bevy is free and open source with good multiplayer performance characteristics. Note: WebAssembly builds currently lack multithreading, and browser-based 3D performance can be inconsistent across devices, though Bevy has shipped real commercial games.

Networking: Real-time transport will use WebSockets (roughly 10 to 50 milliseconds latency) or WebRTC (roughly 5 to 20 milliseconds latency) depending on final tuning. Client-side prediction and interpolation will be used to smooth out perceived lag.

Backend: Server-authoritative model — the server is the source of truth for movement, hits, and kills, rather than trusting client reports, both for fairness and for anti-cheat purposes.

Ledger database: Internal balance tracking in the backend database handles all in-match economy changes; only withdrawals touch the Solana chain directly.

Wallet integration: Players connect a Solana-compatible wallet for deposits and withdrawals.

5. Anti-Cheat and Trust and Safety

Philosophy: Anti-cheat is an ongoing fight, not a one-time solved problem or a launch blocker. Cheat sellers already actively target this genre of real-money shooter, so this risk is treated as certain, not hypothetical.

Core defenses:

- Server-authoritative movement and hit detection, so the server — not the client — decides what actually happened in a fight.
- Behavioral pattern detection to flag statistically implausible performance (e.g. impossible accuracy or reaction times).
- Replay review before a payout is finalized, giving a checkpoint to catch cheating before money moves.

Trust building: Because early adopters in real-money games are highly alert to being scammed or farmed by bots, the platform will be transparent about its limitations while small, rather than overselling polish it doesn't have yet.

6. Go-To-Market and Community Plan

Phase 1 — Discord home base: Launch an official Solatel Discord server with a welcome channel, rules and fair play channel, general chat, and a highlights/payouts channel to build trust through visible proof of payouts.

Phase 2 — Community seeding: Engage authentically in existing Solana and crypto-gaming Discord servers (e.g. Solana Tech, Solana Community) to find early adopters already primed for crypto-based games, inviting genuinely interested players back to the Solatel server.

Phase 3 — X presence: Post build progress, short match clips, and payout receipts on X, engaging with accounts in the Solana gaming space and existing pay-per-kill game communities (e.g. BR1 followers).

Phase 4 — TikTok content engine: Post consistent short-form clips following proven genre formats:

- Direct hook clips: kill happens on screen, followed immediately by the payout amount landing.
- Shock/disbelief reaction clips: framing the mechanic as almost unbelievable, which drives comments and debate.
- Milestone/social proof posts: community earnings totals once there's real traction.
- Founder-authenticity clips: Conrad playing and getting paid out, as the developer, to build early trust that's hard for competitors to copy.

Phase 5 — Scheduled play windows: Announce specific hours where Conrad personally plays and invites a tight circle, concentrating players at the same time so matches fill and feel alive, rather than expecting organic 24-hour traffic early on.

Phase 6 — Referral incentives (mechanics to be finalized separately): Give both the referrer and the new player a small bonus balance on signup, to turn early players into a growth channel.

7. Open Questions and Risks

- **Payment processor decision:** Final choice between Plisio and NOWPayments for initial launch not yet made.
- **Referral bonus mechanics:** Exact bonus amounts and structure for the referral program still to be designed.

- **Browser 3D performance:** Bevy's WebAssembly output currently lacks multithreading, and performance may vary across devices and browsers — needs real-device testing before launch.
- **Anti-cheat effectiveness:** No system is bulletproof at launch; ongoing investment and iteration will be required as cheat developers target the platform.
- **Regulatory exposure:** The platform intentionally avoids jurisdiction-specific framing since access is permissionless via blockchain; this is a deliberate product stance rather than an unresolved question, but worth revisiting as the platform scales.
- **First-player cold start:** Early matches will need concentrated, scheduled play windows to avoid empty lobbies until organic volume builds.